

nication. Basically, because they both know Morse code, they can clench and release their teeth in a pattern that will send a Morse code signal. Since it's just dots and dashes, they can do it by quick and slow clenching of the teeth. This sends the Morse message to the other via a vibrator that is embedded in the same tooth.

Ribas is known for publicity stunts as well, and using a speedometer glove, she was able to get the exact speed she was walking at, as well as the exact speed others around her were traveling at. She used this technology to time the pedestrian crossing signals at Barcelona's Rambla de Catalunya avenue, and create a performance piece that saw her walk at the exact speed needed to be able to walk the whole avenue without ever having to stop for a red light. But that's not all, she also does performances, where she dances according to earthquakes happening around the world. She's connected via the internet to seismographs all across the world, and if it so happens that there's no earthquake happening when you're watching her perform, she just simply stands still!



Moon Ribas is cyborg artist that uses seismographs and speedometer gloves

She's also done other experiments with tech, such as wearing speedometer earrings that vibrate to the movement detected behind her, and thus, in a way, give her 360 degree "vision". I put that in quotes, because while she can see what's in front of her, what's behind her she "sees" through vibrations, not through light.

Rob Spence

After losing an eye in a childhood accident, most people would try and get a glass eye, or wear a cool eye patch, or just try and cover it up somehow. Not Rob Spence, who decided to become an Eyeborg! Like the superheroes he adored when growing up, Rob wanted



The Eyeborg, Phase II

to have some power out of the ordinary... be more than just another human... and thus the idea to have a camera instead of a boring and normal eye was born. With the help of friends he installed a camera and then proceeded to make a documentary of life as (literally) seen through his eye. Of course, people are terrified of privacy invasions with such enhancements, but we should remember that it needs a person to first have one eye gouged out before this can be used against you... so chill! Besides, Rob has a true cyborg look for his eye, and it's complete with a red light to show that it's recording, like most everyday cameras.

OTHERS

There are so many more, and we'd love to list them all, but we still have space and time constraints. There are many people who have enhanced themselves with RFID chips and some even with magnets, such as Rin Räuber. Then there are those who are using headgear to control things, such as startup founder Tiana Sinclair. Finnish coder Jerry Jalava lost a tip of a finger when he crashed his Ducati Monster 696, and replaced it with a prosthetic finger that hides a USB drive under the artificial nail. There are so many more stories like this, and you are sure to come

across an ever increasing number over the coming years. This story might be outdated faster than you might expect!

THE FUTURE

While most often it is the lack of an appendage or a disability that's being turned into enhanced ability by these bodyhackers, we think there are going to be more and more examples of this happening all around the world.

While it may seem cool for now, we also have to realise that there will eventually need to be some laws and regulations put into place for a lot of this, because we certainly don't want people walking about with hidden cameras, broadcasting everything they see, which could invade other people's privacy. Then there's the ethics of allowing people to modify themselves to get super strength, or super speed. Already many prosthetics such as blades worn by runners who have had lower legs amputated can allow them to actually run much faster than if they had normal legs. With more and more research, this would only improve. We're reminded of the game *Portal* where the protagonist Chell has blade enhanced legs.

It's not just being able to run faster that concerns us, but the fact that bi-ionic arms and legs might offer far superior strength, and thus give a cyborg an unfair advantage over others, in various aspects of life where physical ability is important.

Then there's the mental aspect. If it costs a million dollars to get an implant that lets you Google everything directly from your brain, and basically be connected to the internet, wouldn't that constitute an unfair advantage if only some had it. It would be another case where rich kids were scoring the highest on exams, and getting all the top jobs, because us poor folk couldn't afford such implants...

And if this were to happen, would we even be human anymore? But that's beyond the scope of this article, and I think Boo Man has a take on that which might cover these very questions. As always, remember to send us feedback and your thoughts on the actual cyborgs and implants showcased in this article. 